

nLite to slipstream the drivers. Before all this, you can try changing the mode of the SATA controller to IDE in your BIOS by pressing [F2] or [Del] when the PC starts.

System Slow

Q I have a computer with a configuration as follows:

Intel Pentium4 3.00 GHz with HT
Intel 915GAG chipset motherboard
Two DDR 512MB Ram (1 with 333 MHz and the other 400 MHz)
Seagate hard disks (80 GB PATA and 160 GB SATA)
XFX NVIDIA Geforce 8800GT graphic card
Cooler Master 600 W SMPS
Windows XP Professional

Some days back, I found Trojans on my system using True Sword Trial Version (win32.backdoor.haxdoor, winfixer, win32.backdoor. IRCBot, HDAudPropShortcut.exe).

I formatted C:, the primary partition and installed Windows again, as the system was very slow. After installation, I rechecked for Trojans and removed them using True Sword. However, my system is still not performing as per expectations. It takes around three to four minutes to start up Windows. Is this normal? Also, tell me ways to avoid such Trojans that are not detected by free software like Spybot Search and Destroy. I used the trial version of True Sword to get rid of theses Trojans. Can system overheating be the reason for slow performance? I checked the temperature of the processor from BIOS and it ranges from 55 to 64 degrees and with both Zone 1 and Zone 2 around 45 degrees. Is this normal?

Nilesh Thakur

A True Sword is a software meant to remove trojans, spyware and adware, but isn't really an antivirus. Your processor temperature of 64 degrees is high, but shouldn't cause significant slowdown. Three to four minutes is way too long for a Windows startup. Check to see if your hard drive has any problems. You can check for this by copying a large amount of files from one partition to another. Also from device manager, make sure that all drives on the system are running in DMA mode. Sometimes Windows sets drives to run in PIO mode which causes major drops in performance.